

Karen Zheng

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EDUCATION

New York University, Tisch School of the Arts
BFA in Interactive Media Arts | GPA: 3.81

New York, NY
May 2028

Certifications: EA Product Management Simulation (Forage), IBM AI & AI Interaction (SkillsBuild)

Professional Development: Management Leadership for Tomorrow (Career Prep '28, Corporate Management Track), Future Innovators Summit (Hosted by Comcast NBCUniversal)

Relevant Coursework: Human-Centered Product Design, Design I, User Experience Design (Expected F26)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

DuCode Studio | *UX Research Intern* | New York, NY

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Analyzed 18 fintech websites through competitive research, determining user flows and feature strategies
- Identified 40+ UX opportunities that informed product recommendations and feature prioritization
- Led 7+ user interviews, organizing 300+ quotes to uncover user behaviors, pain points, and motivations
- Synthesized 150+ affinity notes into 12 research themes, deciding product requirements and UX improvements

Urban Arts, Game Academy | *Teacher Assistant* | New York, NY

Sep 2024 – Aug 2026

- Designed and taught project-based game design curriculum for 155+ students, covering Unity development, C# programming, interaction logic, and user-centered design principles
- Analyzed student feedback and performance data to optimize learning experiences, improving retention by 21%
- Iterated learning experiences using learner insights, increasing completion rates to 98% (+37% YoY)
- Mentored 70+ students through usability critiques, interaction design decisions, and iterative prototyping practices

PROJECTS

Sustainable Food Carrier | *Human-Centered Design, Physical Prototyping*

Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Conducted 8+ user interviews and 3 competitor analyses to uncover pain points and guide design decisions
- Created and tested 5+ prototype iterations, using research insights to improve usability and accessibility
- Developed a 100% recyclable physical prototype, translating research insights into a sustainable solution that reduces waste and improves user experience

Healthcare Website Redesign (Designathon) | *Figma, Adobe Express*

Apr 2025

- Analyzed 8 healthcare and technology websites to identify UX patterns in product storytelling, content hierarchy, and communicating complex technical solutions
- Partnered with a 3-person team in a 48-hour design hackathon to redesign Altrovia's website experience, improving how users understand its AI-powered clinical trial platform
- Designed 7+ wireframes and high-fidelity prototypes that transformed technical AI workflows into accessible, user-centered website experiences

Voice Powered Video Game | *p5.js, Aseprite, After Effects*

Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Created user flows and wireframes for Color Clash, defining navigation, interaction patterns, and interface structure for a browser-based application
- Built a component-based UI system with reusable design patterns, implementing real-time input handling and state-based interactions to support dynamic user feedback
- Conducted usability testing and performance iterations to refine the interface, delivering a responsive experience with 60 FPS performance and 90%+ speech recognition accuracy

Indie Video Game Design | *Unity, Visual Studio, C#, Aseprite*

Aug 2023 – June 2024

- Applied iterative design to refine player interactions in a game with 400+ players and 600+ views on itch.io
- Designed 15+ character assets and in-game visual experiences, balancing usability and storytelling
- The Vanishing Enigma — Winner of the 2024 Congressional App Challenge (12,682 submissions)

SKILLS

Coding: C#, Python, JavaScript, p5.js, Java, HTML, CSS

Design & Tools: Figma, Unity, Adobe Creative Suite, Aseprite, Visual Studio, Google Suite